

Check Pangram

Problem Statement

Given a string `s`, check whether it is a **Pangram** or not.

A **Pangram** is a sentence that contains **every letter of the English alphabet at least once**, regardless of whether the letters are uppercase or lowercase.

There are exactly **26 English alphabet letters**:

```
a, b, c, d, e, f, g, h, i, j, k, l, m,  
n, o, p, q, r, s, t, u, v, w, x, y, z
```

The string may contain:

- Uppercase letters
- Lowercase letters
- Spaces
- Numbers
- Special characters

Only the English alphabet letters are considered.

Example 1

Input

```
s = "Bawds jog, flick quartz, vex nymph"
```

Output

```
true
```

Explanation

The sentence contains all 26 English alphabet letters.

Therefore, it is a pangram.

Example 2

Input

```
s = "The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog"
```

Output

```
true
```

This is a famous English pangram because it contains every letter from `a` to `z`.

Example 3

Input

```
s = "Hello World"
```

Output

```
false
```

Many alphabet characters are missing, such as:

```
a, b, c, d, ...
```

Therefore, it is not a pangram.

Approach

Your solution uses a `HashMap<Character, Integer>`.

The main steps are:

1. Remove non-alphabetic characters.
2. Convert the string into a character array.
3. If fewer than 26 characters remain, return false.
4. Convert uppercase letters to lowercase.
5. Store every character in a HashMap.
6. Check whether every character from 'a' to 'z' exists.
7. If all 26 letters exist, return true.

Java Implementation

```
class Solution {
    public static boolean checkPangram(String s) {

        HashMap<Character, Integer> map = new HashMap<>();

        String str = s.replaceAll("[^a-zA-Z]", "");

        char[] arr = str.toCharArray();

        if (arr.length < 26) {
            return false;
        }

        for (char ch : arr) {

            if (Character.isLetter(ch)) {
                ch = Character.toLowerCase(ch);

                map.put(ch, map.getOrDefault(ch, 0) + 1);
            }
        }

        for (char ch = 'a'; ch <= 'z'; ch++) {

            if (!map.containsKey(ch)) {
                return false;
            }
        }

        return true;
    }
}
```

Code Explanation

1. Create HashMap

```
HashMap<Character, Integer> map = new HashMap<>();
```

The HashMap stores each alphabet character and its frequency.

For example:

```
a → 2  
b → 1  
c → 3  
...
```

We don't actually need the frequency to determine a pangram, but your approach stores it while counting.

2. Remove Non-Alphabet Characters

```
String str = s.replaceAll("[^a-zA-Z]", "");
```

This removes everything except English alphabet letters.

Understanding the Regular Expression

```
[a-zA-Z]
```

means:

```
a-z → lowercase letters  
A-Z → uppercase letters
```

The `^` inside `[]` means **NOT**.

Therefore:

```
[^a-zA-Z]
```

means:

Any character that is NOT an English alphabet letter.

Example

Input:

```
"Bawds jog, flick quartz, vex nymph!"
```

After:

```
s.replaceAll("[^a-zA-Z]", "")
```

we get:

```
"Bawdsjogflickquartzvexnymph"
```

Spaces, commas, and other special characters are removed.

3. Convert String to Character Array

```
char[] arr = str.toCharArray();
```

For:

```
str = "Hello"
```

we get:

```
arr = ['H', 'e', 'l', 'l', 'o']
```

This allows us to process each character using a for-each loop.

4. Check Length

```
if (arr.length < 26) {  
    return false;  
}
```

There are exactly 26 English letters.

If the string contains fewer than 26 alphabetic characters, it is **impossible** for all 26 different letters to be present.

For example:

```
s = "abcdefghijklmnopqrst"
```

Number of letters:

```
20
```

Since:

```
20 < 26
```

we can immediately return:

```
false
```

This is an early optimization.

Important

Having at least 26 characters does **not** guarantee a pangram.

For example:

```
"aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa"
```

has 26 characters but contains only `a`.

So we still need to check all 26 letters.

5. Traverse the Characters

```
for (char ch : arr)
```

This visits every character in the array.

For example:

```
arr = ['H', 'e', 'L', 'l', '0']
```

The loop processes:

```
H  
e  
L  
l  
0
```

6. Check Whether It Is a Letter

```
if (Character.isLetter(ch))
```

This checks whether the character is a letter.

In your code this check is somewhat redundant because:

```
s.replaceAll("[^a-zA-Z]", "")
```

has already removed non-English letters.

So this:

```
if (Character.isLetter(ch))
```

is not strictly necessary.

But it does not cause a problem.

7. Convert Uppercase to Lowercase

```
ch = Character.toLowerCase(ch);
```

This is important because:

```
'A'
```

and:

```
'a'
```

should represent the same alphabet letter.

For example:

```
'A' → 'a'  
'B' → 'b'  
'Z' → 'z'
```

Without this conversion, uppercase and lowercase letters would be treated as different keys in the HashMap.

8. Count the Character

```
map.put(ch, map.getOrDefault(ch, 0) + 1);
```

This counts the frequency of each character.

`getOrDefault()`

```
map.getOrDefault(ch, 0)
```

means:

If `ch` exists in the map, return its current value. Otherwise return `0`.

Then:

```
+ 1
```

increments the frequency.

Example

Suppose:

```
s = "Apple"
```

Characters after converting to lowercase:

```
a p p l e
```

Processing:

`a`

```
a → 1
```

First `p`

```
p → 1
```

Second `p`

```
p → 2
```

l

l → 1

e

e → 1

Final map:

a → 1
p → 2
l → 1
e → 1

9. Check All 26 Letters

```
for (char ch = 'a'; ch <= 'z'; ch++)
```

This loop goes through:

a
b
c
d
...
z

There are exactly 26 iterations.

10. Check `containsKey()`

```
if (!map.containsKey(ch))  
{
```

```
        return false;
    }
```

`containsKey()` checks whether a character exists in the HashMap.

For example:

```
map.containsKey('a')
```

returns:

```
true
```

if `a` exists.

If even one alphabet character is missing:

```
return false;
```

11. Return True

If the loop successfully checks all characters:

```
a → present
b → present
c → present
...
z → present
```

then:

```
return true;
```

The string is a pangram.

Dry Run

Consider:

```
s = "The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog"
```

Step 1: Remove non-letters

```
Thequickbrownfoxjumpsoverthelazydog
```

Step 2: Convert to lowercase

```
thequickbrownfoxjumpsoverthelazydog
```

Step 3: Store characters

The HashMap contains:

```
a → present  
b → present  
c → present  
d → present  
e → present  
f → present  
g → present  
h → present  
i → present  
j → present  
k → present  
l → present  
m → present  
n → present  
o → present  
p → present  
q → present  
r → present  
s → present  
t → present  
u → present  
v → present  
w → present  
x → present
```

```
y → present  
z → present
```

All 26 letters exist.

Therefore:

```
Output = true
```

Dry Run with Missing Character

Consider:

```
s = "abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxy"
```

The string contains:

```
a → y
```

but does not contain:

```
z
```

During the final loop:

```
ch = 'z'
```

The condition:

```
!map.containsKey('z')
```

becomes:

```
true
```

Therefore:

```
return false;
```

Iteration Example

For:

```
s = "abc...xyz"
```

The final loop works like:

Iteration	ch	Present?
1	a	Yes
2	b	Yes
3	c	Yes
...	...	...
24	x	Yes
25	y	Yes
26	z	Yes

After all 26 characters are found:

```
return true;
```

Why Case Conversion Is Needed

Consider:

```
s = "Abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz"
```

There are all 26 letters, but **A** is uppercase.

If we did not convert:

```
Character.toLowerCase(ch)
```

the map could contain:

```
A  
b  
c  
d  
...  
z
```

Then:

```
map.containsKey('a')
```

would be false.

So:

```
ch = Character.toLowerCase(ch);
```

makes:

```
A → a  
B → b  
C → c
```

and allows uppercase and lowercase to be treated equally.

Why We Don't Need Character Frequency

For a pangram, we only need to know:

Does each letter exist at least once?

We don't care whether:

a → 1

or:

a → 100

Both mean that **a** is present.

Therefore, an alternative is to use:

HashSet<Character>

instead of:

HashMap<Character, Integer>

A **HashSet** stores only unique characters.

Alternative HashSet Approach

```
class Solution {
    public static boolean checkPangram(String s) {

        HashSet<Character> set = new HashSet<>();

        for (char ch : s.toCharArray()) {

            if (ch >= 'A' && ch <= 'Z') {
                ch = Character.toLowerCase(ch);
            }

            if (ch >= 'a' && ch <= 'z') {
                set.add(ch);
            }
        }

        return set.size() == 26;
    }
}
```


This is simpler because we only care about whether each character exists.

Even More Efficient Approach

Because there are only 26 lowercase English letters, we can use a boolean array:

```
boolean[] seen = new boolean[26];
```

For a character:

```
seen[ch - 'a'] = true;
```

Then check all 26 positions.

This avoids the HashMap.

Edge Cases

1. Empty String

```
Input:  
""  
  
Output:  
false
```

2. Less Than 26 Letters

```
Input:  
"hello"  
  
Output:  
false
```

3. Uppercase Letters

Input:
"ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ"

Output:
true

Because uppercase letters are converted to lowercase.

4. Numbers and Symbols

Input:
"123!@#abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz"

Numbers and symbols are ignored.

Output:

true

5. Repeated Characters

Input:
"aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa"

Even though there are more than 26 characters, only `a` is present.

Output:

false

DSA Concepts Used

- String manipulation

- Character array
 - HashMap
 - Frequency counting
 - Regular expressions
 - Character conversion
 - HashMap `containsKey()`
 - `getOrDefault()`
 - Iteration
-

Important Java Methods

`replaceAll()`

```
s.replaceAll("[^a-zA-Z]", "")
```

Removes all non-English alphabet characters.

`toCharArray()`

```
s.toCharArray()
```

Converts a string into a character array.

`Character.toLowerCase()`

```
Character.toLowerCase(ch)
```

Converts uppercase letters to lowercase.

`getOrDefault()`

```
map.getOrDefault(ch, 0)
```

Returns the existing frequency or `0`.

`containsKey()`

```
map.containsKey(ch)
```

Checks whether the character exists in the map.

Complexity Analysis

Let `n` be the length of the input string.

Time Complexity

The string is processed once:

$O(n)$

Then we check 26 letters:

$O(26)$

Since 26 is constant:

$O(1)$

Therefore:

Overall Time Complexity = $O(n)$

Space Complexity

The HashMap can contain at most 26 English letters:

$O(26)$

Since 26 is constant:

Space Complexity = $O(1)$

Note: Your `replaceAll()` and `toCharArray()` create additional temporary storage proportional to the input length, so if counting all implementation-level allocations, the actual auxiliary space can be $O(n)$.

Key Takeaway

The main idea is:

```
Input String
  ↓
Remove non-alphabet characters
  ↓
Convert uppercase → lowercase
  ↓
Store characters in HashMap
  ↓
Check a → z
  ↓
If all 26 exist → true
Otherwise → false
```

The most important condition is:

```
for (char ch = 'a'; ch <= 'z'; ch++) {
    if (!map.containsKey(ch)) {
        return false;
    }
}
```

It explicitly verifies that **every English alphabet letter is present**.

Final Complexity

```
Time Complexity : O(n)
Space Complexity : O(1) auxiliary for the 26-letter map
```

Core DSA pattern: Character Frequency / Presence Checking using a HashMap.